

Kibanda × Factorial

Brenda's story

How a four-branch Nairobi restaurant group automates its people processes, with Kenyan employment requirements along the way.

MEET BRENDA

Brenda Wanjiru runs Kibanda, four restaurants across Nairobi with 46 people, and she wants her Sundays back.

Kibanda started in 2019 on Moi Avenue as one busy CBD eatery serving chapati, beans and chai to office workers. Today there are four branches: CBD, Westlands, Kilimani and Karen, plus a small head office above the Kilimani branch.

Branch	Manager	Staff	Character
Kibanda CBD	Faith Chebet Rotich	11	Opens 06:30 for the breakfast rush
Kibanda Westlands	Grace Wanjiku Kamau	11	Lunch meetings, busy weekends
Kibanda Kilimani	Daniel Otieno Ochieng	10	Deliveries and evening crowd
Kibanda Karen	Peter Mutua Musyoka	10	Family brunch, closed Mondays
Head office	Brenda Wanjiru	4	HR, accounts, procurement

On a typical Sunday evening, Brenda does the same tasks every week:

- She builds next week's rota in a WhatsApp group, and three people reply "sawa" to shifts they cannot work.
- She counts leave days from a notebook that Faith keeps in the CBD office.
- She reconciles M-Pesa messages against a shoebox of receipts from Wakulima Market.
- She checks whether the new minimum wage from May 2026 actually reached every payslip.

Esther, her HR & Admin Officer, spends the first week of every month chasing timesheets so payroll can close before the 9th. Brenda knows the business has outgrown paper. She also knows one missed contract or unpaid overtime claim could cost her more than a year of software.

This story follows Brenda through her first year on Factorial, one module at a time.

CHAPTER 1 · EMPLOYEE PLATFORM & OPERATIONS

One home for every employee

Brenda starts by moving all 46 people into Factorial with one spreadsheet import. For the first time she can see every branch, role and manager in a single org chart.

Contracts and agreements. Esther discovers that three long-serving waiters never signed a written contract. Kenyan law requires one for anyone employed for more than three months. She generates contracts from a Kibanda template and sends them through **E-Signature**. Every waiter signs on their phone between shifts.

KENYA REQUIREMENT

Written contract (Employment Act 2007, s.9–10)

Anyone employed for three months or more needs a written contract. It must state the job, start date, pay, hours, leave, notice period and place of work. Failing to provide one can attract a fine of up to KES 100,000.

Onboarding with Workflows. When Tom Kiplagat Sang joins Westlands as a casual waiter, a workflow triggers automatically. Grace receives a checklist: upload his ID copy, KRA PIN, NSSF and SHA numbers, and his food handler medical certificate. Tom gets a welcome message and the Kibanda handbook to acknowledge.

Document Management. Medical certificates, contracts and warning letters now live in each employee's profile. Factorial reminds Esther 30 days before any certificate expires, so a county health inspection is no longer a scramble.

KENYA REQUIREMENT

Records (Employment Act s.74) and data protection (Data Protection Act 2019)

Employers must keep employment records, including pay and leave, for at least five years after an employee leaves. Personal data such as ID numbers and medical certificates must be stored securely, with access limited to people who need it.

Probation. Eric Mutua Kyalo joined Kilimani on probation in July. Factorial shows his probation end date, 6 January 2027, and nudges Daniel to complete a review before then.

KENYA REQUIREMENT

Probation (Employment Act s.42)

Probation may last up to six months. It can be extended by up to six more months only with the employee's agreement. Either side may end the contract during probation with seven days' notice.

CHAPTER 2 · OPERATIONS

Rotas that respect the law

Shift Management. Grace builds the Westlands rota for the week of 5 October from six shift templates instead of WhatsApp messages.

Code	Shift	Hours	Paid hours
PREP	Kitchen prep	05:30–14:00	8
AM	Morning service	06:30–15:00	8
PM	Evening service	13:30–22:00	8
SPLIT	Lunch and dinner split	10:30–14:30, 17:30–21:30	8
WKND	Weekend brunch	08:00–16:30	8
OFF	Office day	08:30–17:30	8

When she drags Tom onto a seventh straight day, Factorial flags it: no rest day and 56 hours scheduled. Grace moves his Sunday PM shift to Dennis before anyone sees the rota. Staff get their shifts in the Factorial app, and swap requests go to Grace for approval.

KENYA REQUIREMENT

Hours and rest (Employment Act s.27; Regulation of Wages (General) Order)

Every employee is entitled to at least one rest day in every seven days. The general wage order sets a normal week of 52 hours over six days, or 60 hours for night workers. Overtime is paid at 1.5 times the hourly rate, and at 2 times on rest days and public holidays.

Time Tracking. Staff clock in on the Factorial app when they arrive, with the branch location attached. Esther no longer rebuilds hours from memory: overtime is calculated from real clock-ins and flows straight into pre-payroll. On Mashujaa Day, 20 October, anyone who works is automatically marked for double pay.

Time Off. Kibanda's leave policy is set up once, and every employee sees their own balance on their phone.

Leave type	Entitlement	Legal basis
Annual	21 working days a year, accruing 1.75 days a month	Employment Act s.28
Sick	7 days full pay + 7 days half pay a year, after 2 months' service	s.30
Maternity	3 months, full pay	s.29
Paternity	2 weeks, full pay	s.29(8)
Pre-adoptive	1 month, full pay	s.29A (Employment (Amendment) Act 2021)
Compassionate	3 working days	Kibanda policy

Mary Achieng Odhiambo at CBD requests leave for her sister's wedding in Kisumu. Faith approves it in two taps, and the rota shows the gap immediately. When Cynthia at Karen announces she is expecting, Factorial calculates her three months of maternity leave and her return date.

KENYA REQUIREMENT

Leave cannot be traded away

The Act's leave and working-time terms are minimums. Any agreement that gives an employee less is void. Dismissing someone for being pregnant or for taking lawful leave is automatically unfair.

CHAPTER 3 · PRE & POST-PAYROLL

Payroll closes before the 9th

By the last week of September, hours, overtime, leave and new joiners are already in Factorial. Esther reviews one pre-payroll screen instead of four branch spreadsheets. She sends it to Kibanda's payroll provider in one export.

The minimum wage check. In May 2026 the government raised minimum wages by 12%. Factorial compares every basic salary with the new floor for that role. Every Kibanda salary passes; the lowest waiter's basic is KES 21,000 against a floor of KES 19,491.

KENYA REQUIREMENT

Minimum wage (Regulation of Wages (General) (Amendment) Order 2026)

New rates took effect on 1 May 2026, with arrears due from that date. In Nairobi, waiters and cooks earn at least KES 19,491 a month; cleaners and general workers earn at least KES 18,047.40. These figures are basic pay: housing, or a housing allowance, comes on top. Casual workers must be paid at the end of each day.

What a payslip looks like. Here are two Westlands employees for September 2026:

KES per month	Brian Wafula (Waiter)	Lucy Wairimu (Cashier)
Gross pay (basic + 15% housing allowance)	26,450	34,500
NSSF (Tier I + Tier II, 6%)	1,587	2,070
SHIF (2.75%)	727	949
Housing Levy (1.5%)	397	518
PAYE after KES 2,400 relief	0	1,741
Net pay	23,739	29,223
Employer cost (+ NSSF and Housing Levy match)	28,434	37,088

Across the 43 salaried staff, September gross payroll is KES 1.80 million, and total employer cost is KES 1.94 million. Factorial sends Esther a reminder on 5 October: PAYE, NSSF, SHIF and the Housing Levy are all due by 9 October.

KENYA REQUIREMENT

Statutory deductions (as at September 2026)

- **PAYE:** 10% up to KES 24,000, then 25%, 30%, 32.5% and 35% above KES 800,000, less KES 2,400 personal relief. The Finance Act 2026 left these bands unchanged.
- **NSSF:** 6% from employee and 6% from employer, on pay up to KES 108,000 (Tier I up to KES 9,000). The maximum is KES 6,480 each.
- **SHIF:** 2.75% of gross pay, minimum KES 300.
- **Affordable Housing Levy:** 1.5% from employee, matched by 1.5% from employer.
- All four are due by the 9th of the following month. Late SHIF and Housing Levy payments attract a 3% monthly penalty.
- Total deductions may not exceed two-thirds of an employee's wages (Employment Act s.19).

Post-payroll. Payslips land in each employee's Factorial app. Staff no longer queue at the CBD office to ask for a P9 or a payslip for a SACCO loan.

CHAPTER 4 · TALENT

Hiring for the December rush

Recruitment. December is Kibanda's busiest month, so in September Brenda opens fixed-term waiter roles, a cook role and a barista role. Adverts go out from one Factorial careers page, and CVs from walk-ins are uploaded into the same pipeline.

Candidate	Role	Branch	Stage	Next step
Samson Karisa	Waiter (fixed-term)	Westlands	Offer	Contract sent for e-signature
Lydia Wanjala	Waiter (fixed-term)	Westlands	Interview	Trial shift on Sat 10 Oct
Rehema Chepkoech	Cook	CBD	Interview	Cook-off with Paul Kipchumba
Felix Mwangi	Cook	CBD	Trial shift	Food handler certificate check
Halima Omar	Waiter (fixed-term)	Karen	Screening	Phone screen with Peter
Duncan Ochieng	Delivery Rider	Karen	Hired	Starts 12 Oct

Branch managers score candidates in the same place. When Samson accepts, his profile, contract and onboarding workflow are created without anyone retyping his details.

KENYA REQUIREMENT

Fair hiring (Employment Act s.5; Persons with Disabilities Act 2025)

Employers may not discriminate on grounds such as sex, pregnancy, ethnicity, religion, disability or HIV status, and must pay equal pay for work of equal value. Employers with 20 or more staff must reserve at least 5% of roles for persons with disabilities. At 46 people, Kibanda needs at least three, and Factorial's headcount reports make that target visible.

Trainings. Esther schedules fire safety training and food hygiene refreshers per branch. Attendance and certificates are recorded against each employee.

KENYA REQUIREMENT

Workplace safety (Occupational Safety and Health Act 2007)

Employers must provide a safe workplace, train staff on hazards, and keep safety records. Food handlers also need valid medical certificates under public health rules.

Performance and Goals. Each branch manager has two goals for the quarter: average ticket size and customer rating. Twice a year, every employee gets a short review on the Factorial app. Kitchen stewards who want to become cooks can see what they need to get there.

Employee Satisfaction. A monthly two-question survey asks staff how their week went. When Kilimani scores drop in August, Brenda learns that the evening shift ends too late for the last matatu. She changes the PM shift closing routine before she loses good people.

CHAPTER 5 · FINANCE

Goodbye to the shoebox

Expenses. When Paul buys sukuma, tomatoes and onions at Wakulima Market at 5am, he pays by M-Pesa and snaps the receipt in the Factorial app. The expense is tagged to Kibanda CBD before he is back in the kitchen.

Date	Branch	By	What	Paid via	KES	Status
26 Sep	HQ	Esther Nyambura	Fire safety training	Bank transfer	25,000	Pending
22 Sep	CBD	Faith Chebet	Food handler medical certificates (6)	M-Pesa Paybill	9,000	Approved
18 Sep	Westlands	Grace Wanjiku	Fridge repair	M-Pesa	7,500	Query: receipt missing
15 Sep	HQ	Hassan Abdi	Takeaway packaging	Bank transfer	41,200	Approved
7 Sep	Karen	Peter Mutua	LPG gas	M-Pesa Till	12,800	Approved
3 Sep	Westlands	Joseph Njoroge	Meat	M-Pesa Till	32,600	Approved
1 Sep	CBD	Paul Kipchumba	Produce, Wakulima Market	M-Pesa Paybill	18,450	Approved

Samuel, the accountant, sees the missing fridge repair receipt flagged before month end, not during the audit.

Procurement and Accounts Payable. Hassan raises purchase requests for packaging and gas. Brenda approves anything over KES 20,000 from her phone. Supplier invoices are matched to orders, and Samuel checks that each one carries a valid eTIMS invoice so it counts for tax.

Projects and Costs Tracking. Every shift, salary and expense is tagged to a branch. For the first time, Brenda can compare labour cost against sales for each restaurant. She sees that Karen's weekday lunch is overstaffed and moves one waiter to the Saturday brunch.

Software Management. Samuel tracks Kibanda's subscriptions — the POS system, delivery apps and Factorial — in one list, with renewal dates and owners.

One year on

A year later, Brenda opens one dashboard on Sunday evening instead of four WhatsApp groups. She can see headcount and labour cost by branch, overtime hours, leave balances, and open vacancies.

- **Rotas** are published two weeks ahead, and no one works seven days straight.
- **Payroll** closes by the 3rd of each month, and statutory payments are never late.
- **Every employee** has a signed contract, a current medical certificate and a leave balance they can check themselves.
- **Esther** spends her first week of the month on hiring and training, not chasing timesheets.

When Brenda opens a fifth branch, in Ruaka, she copies Kilimani's shift templates and leave policy. The new team is onboarded in a day.

KENYA REQUIREMENT

One zoning note for Ruaka

Ruaka sits outside Nairobi's city zone, so a different minimum wage band may apply. Brenda confirms the right band before she sets Ruaka's salaries.

Kenyan employment requirements — checklist

These are the requirements the story touches, grouped as an employer would check them. They reflect the Employment Act 2007 as amended, the 2026 wage orders and the Finance Act 2026. Use them for demo conversations, not as legal advice.

Hiring and contracts

- ☐ Written contract for anyone employed three months or more, stating job, pay, hours, leave and notice (Employment Act s.9–10)
- ☐ Probation of no more than six months, extendable by six only with consent (s.42)
- ☐ No discrimination in hiring, pay or promotion; equal pay for work of equal value (s.5)
- ☐ At least 5% of roles for persons with disabilities where you have 20 or more staff (Persons with Disabilities Act 2025)
- ☐ Sexual harassment policy where you have 20 or more staff (s.6)
- ☐ Registered with KRA (PAYE), NSSF and SHA before the first payroll

Pay

- ☐ Basic pay at or above the minimum for the role and zone, effective 1 May 2026; Nairobi waiters and cooks KES 19,491, cleaners and general workers KES 18,047.40
- ☐ Housing provided, or a housing allowance on top of basic pay
- ☐ Casual workers paid at the end of each day
- ☐ Itemised payslip for every pay period (s.20)
- ☐ Deductions only as the law allows, and never more than two-thirds of wages (s.19)
- ☐ PAYE, NSSF (6% + 6%, up to KES 108,000), SHIF (2.75%, minimum KES 300) and Housing Levy (1.5% + 1.5%) remitted by the 9th

Hours and leave

- ☐ At least one rest day in every seven (s.27)
- ☐ Normal week of 52 hours (60 for night work); overtime at 1.5x, and 2x on rest days and public holidays
- ☐ 21 working days' annual leave after 12 months of service (s.28)
- ☐ Sick leave of 7 days full pay + 7 days half pay after two months (s.30)
- ☐ Maternity leave of three months, paternity leave of two weeks, and pre-adoptive leave of one month (s.29, s.29A)
- ☐ All gazetted public holidays observed or paid

Records, safety and exits

- ☐ Employment records kept for five years after an employee leaves (s.74)
- ☐ Employee data held securely, with limited access (Data Protection Act 2019)
- ☐ Safe workplace, safety training and valid food handler medical certificates (OSHA 2007; public health rules)
- ☐ Termination only for a valid reason, after a fair hearing, with written notice: 28 days for monthly-paid staff, 7 days during probation (s.35, s.41, s.45)
- ☐ Redundancy: 30 days' notice to the employee and labour officer, and severance of at least 15 days' pay per year of service (s.40)
- ☐ Certificate of service for every employee who leaves (s.51)

Demo click-path

Load the **Kibanda_Factorial_Demo_Data.xlsx** workbook, then follow the story in this order. The whole walkthrough takes about 25 minutes.

- 1 **Org chart** — show the four branches, head office and 46 people (Employees and Locations tabs).
- 2 **Contracts and e-signature** — send a contract to Brian Wafula Wekesa.
- 3 **Onboarding workflow** — Tom Kiplagat Sang's checklist at Westlands.
- 4 **Shift planner** — Westlands, week of 5 October; show the flag on Tom's seventh day (Rota tab).
- 5 **Clock-in** — the mobile app, with location.
- 6 **Time off** — approve Mary Achieng's leave; show balances and a maternity calculation.
- 7 **Pre-payroll** — the September summary and the minimum wage check (Pre-payroll tab).
- 8 **Recruitment** — the December hiring pipeline; move Samson Karisa to Hired.
- 9 **Expenses** — Paul's Wakulima Market receipt and the fridge repair query.
- 10 **Reports** — labour cost by branch.

Before a live demo, check two things: the exact wage-order category for cashiers, baristas and riders, and the gazetted public holidays for the rest of 2026.

SOURCES

[Employment Act 2007, as amended — Kenya Law](#)

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[Kenya Minimum Wage Guide 2026 — Grant Thornton](#)

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[Recent employment law reforms in Kenya — DLA Piper](#)

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